# Round & about

We bring you the latest news from the world of woodturning as well as letters from the Woodworkers Institute forum and important dates for your diary from the woodturning community

## A sneak peek at the AAW's new services

The American Association of Woodturners (AAW) has played a crucial role in the development of contemporary woodturning and has led a dramatic transformation of the craft since it was established in 1986. At its 30th annual international symposium in Atlanta, Georgia, 9–12 June, 2016, AAW will gather woodturners from around the world to celebrate this important milestone while enjoying three-and-a-half days of classroom-type woodturning demonstrations and panel discussions. Attendees will also have the opportunity to hear about the new ways the AAW is enhancing its educational offerings to better meet the needs of woodturners of all skill levels. Here is a sneak peek at two of AAW's new learning services that will be launched at the event.

### New AAW symposium hands-on woodturning experiences

During the 2016 symposium in Atlanta, AAW's Women in Turning (WIT) committee will offer seven hands-on educational woodturning experiences and two discussion rotations, which are open to all registered symposium attendees. The sessions will be focused on skill-building and will be managed by accomplished and renowned women in the field of woodturning.

Sally Ault, a 2016 WIT hands-on room instructor, turns a bowl

These new hands-on sessions will complement the AAW's traditional classroom style demonstrations and lectures. Like other experiential learning opportunities, these foundational hands-on sessions are expected to boost both comprehension and retention, as well as help attendees build strong basic woodturning techniques and implement appropriate safety practices.

The proposed hands-on sessions and discussion rotations include: Making A Tool & Free-Hand Sharpening; End Grain Cutting; Multi-Axis/Offset Turning; Green Wood Natural Edge Bowls; Woodturning Joinery; Equipment: Bandsaws, Sharpening With Jigs, Chucks & Faceplates; Embellishing: Pyrography, Texturing, Colouring; Ask an Expert/Become an Expert! (Panel Discussion); and, Identity & Personal Expression in Turned Artwork (Panel Discussion).

Registration for the hands-on sessions will be limited and determined on a first come, first served basis. Registered symposium attendees who are interested in participating in any of the rotations, must pre-register on the form at the bottom of the AAW's WIT Hands-On Room webpage at tiny.cc/WITHandsOn. Once the symposium schedule is finalised, attendees will receive an email inviting them to officially register for specific rotations. Depending on response, individuals may be limited to a specified number of rotations.

### New AAW video channel for premium woodturning videos

Websites like YouTube and Vimeo can be valuable resources for learning on a wide range of topics including woodturning. However, users may sometimes feel overwhelmed when performing a topic search. For example, a recent YouTube search for 'Woodturning a Segmented Bowl' displayed more than 23,800 results. How do you know which videos to watch? Some are poorly produced, others are not very informative and some even illustrate improper and dangerous methods.

To help resolve this issue, AAW will introduce its new specialised video channel, AAWVideoSource.org, at the 2016 symposium in Atlanta. The channel will showcase and link to high-quality woodturning videos that have been pre-screened for quality content, production value and safety techniques. A robust search engine will feature keyword selection to help users effectively choose desired videos, and search results will display the turner/author's name, a short description of the video and total running time. Focusing on quality vs quantity, AAW anticipates that AAWVideoSource.org will become the 'go to' resource for excellent woodturning education videos. Woodturners of all skill levels will learn faster and have more time to spend turning by avoiding junk videos and extra clutter.

The AAW is launching a new video channel

In addition to introducing new services, AAW's 30th annual international symposium in Atlanta, Georgia, 9–12 June, 2016, will offer something for woodturners of all skill levels. Attendees may select from a broad range of demonstrations and panel discussions to focus on sessions that will enhance their woodturning experience the most. Symposium registration is open and early bird rates are effective through 1 May, 2016. To learn more about the AAW's 30th annual international symposium, visit tiny.cc/AAW2016Atlanta. For more about the AAW, visit woodturner.org

ATLANTA 2016
AAW AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF WOODTURNERS SYMPOSIUM
30 YEARS 1986-2016

The AAW's 30th annual symposium will be held in Atlanta in June



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